

Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεύς

Iamblichus of Chalcis on the Pythagorean Life and Mysteries

eul_aid: udw

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Neoplatonist](#)

Iamblichus was a Syrian philosopher who lived in the late 3rd and early 4th centuries CE, from approximately 245 to 325 CE. He was a major figure in the Neoplatonist school of thought. Born into a wealthy family in Chalcis, he studied under Porphyry, a student of the founder of Neoplatonism, Plotinus. Iamblichus later returned to Syria to establish his own influential school.

His writings aimed to create a comprehensive and systematic form of Platonism. His surviving works include *On the Pythagorean Life*, a biography of Pythagoras; the *Protrepticus*, an exhortation to study philosophy; and several treatises on mathematics and the mystical properties of numbers. His most famous work is *On the Mysteries of the Egyptians*, which defends the use of ritual practice, known as theurgy, as a path to the divine. Many of his other works, including commentaries on Plato and Aristotle, are lost and known only through fragments.

Iamblichus is a pivotal figure for moving Neoplatonism in a more religious direction. His most significant contribution was his detailed philosophical justification for theurgy, arguing that ritual acts were essential for the soul's ascent to the divine, a view that contrasted with a focus on pure intellectual contemplation. He also developed a complex hierarchy of divine beings. This theurgical Platonism, often called the Syrian School, dominated later Neoplatonic thought and influenced subsequent philosophers, including the Emperor Julian and Proclus.

Works (6)

- [περὶ τοῦ Πυθαγορικοῦ βίου λόγος](#) · [Discourse-the Pythagorean Life](#) · 278 passages
- [Προτρεπτικός](#) · [Exhortation](#) · 124 passages
- [Περὶ τῆς κοινῆς μαθηματικῆς ἐπιστήμης](#) · [On Common Mathematical Knowledge](#) · 84 passages
- [Περὶ τῆς Νικομάχου ἀριθμητικῆς εἰσαγωγῆς](#) · [On Nicomachus' Introduction to Arithmetic](#) · 123 passages
- [Περὶ τῶν Μυστηρίων](#) · [On the Mysteries](#) · 166 passages
- [Θεολογικὴ Ἀριθμητικὴ](#) · [Theological Arithmetic](#) · 86 passages

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- [Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολή](#) · [Amelius Letters](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς](#) · [Ammonius of Alexandria Phil](#) · 5 works
- [Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός](#) · [Damascius of Damascus](#) · 7 works

- [Δαβίδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible · 2 works](#)
- [Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist · 1 work](#)
- [Ἡλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Elias the Neoplatonist · 3 works](#)
- [Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus · 1 work](#)
- [Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεύς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II · 1 work](#)
- [Ἰουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης · Julian the Apostate · 20 works](#)
- [Μαρῖνος ὁ Νεαπολίτης · Marinus of Neapolis · 1 work](#)